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2020 elections: L.A. County's Assembly races at a glance

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Author: Josh Rosen | Section: News | 5496 Words
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Here's a glimpse of Assembly races coming up on Nov. 3 that involve Los Angeles County voters.

District 36: Tom Lackey (R) vs. Steve Fox (D)

* The district: Encompasses a wide swath of people in Eastern Kern, Northern L.A., and Western San Bernardino counties, and includes the cities of California City, Mojave, Rosamond, Acton, Lancaster, Littlerock, Palmdale, Quartz Hill, Piñon Hills, Wrightwood, and parts of Phelan. Of the 463,038 people living in District 36, the majority are Latino (41.60%), though the White population is almost as numerous (37.67%), and the Black population is the third biggest (14.11%). Less than 5% of the population is Asian, and less than 1% is Native American.

* The incumbent: Tom Lackey, the Republican from Palmdale, was originally a special education teacher before he became a California Highway Patrolman for 28 years. Sometimes portrayed as one of the Assembly's more moderate Republicans, Lackey spent 2019 voting against measures that would increase oversight over the police and sheriff's departments, voting against environmental protections, and voting against the rights of tenants. Motorists might recognize him as the author of the bill that legalized lane-splitting.

* The challenger: Steve Fox, last decade's main challenger to Lackey, was not endorsed by the Democratic Party this year. Also from Palmdale, Fox was sued twice in 2014 by two former employees; one alleging he created a hostile work environment and exposed himself to her, and the other for unpaid wages. Fox denies the allegations, but both suits were settled, and the costs were paid by the Assembly to the tune of $210,000.

* The outlook: District 36 is one of only 17 seats in the Assembly controlled by a Republican. If the names Tom Lackey and Steve Fox sound familiar, it's because the two of them have been fighting over the seat since 2012. Aside from a two-year period from 2012 to 2014 where Steve Fox was able to nab the seat for the Democrats, the seat has gone to a Republican candidate for almost 30 years. Nevertheless, demographically the district leans towards the Democrats, so it could go either way.

District 70: Patrick O'Donnell (D) vs. David Thomas (R)

* The district: District 70 runs along the coast and ports of L.A. County, and includes approximately 468,514 residents in Avalon, Long Beach, L.A., San Pedro, and Signal Hill. Over the past decade, District 70 has been controlled by the Democrats, though interestingly their primary challenger in the 2018 election was not a Republican, but a Libertarian. The district is primarily Latino (38.71%) and White (35.12%), though there are a significant number of Asian (12.80%) and Black (10.83%) people throughout. Just over half of the voters in the district are registered Democrats, and there are more voters with no party preference than registered Republicans.

* The Incumbent: Patrick O'Donnell stands up for public education and labor, and not much else. He regularly abstains from tough votes, often against the will of his progressive district. He is notoriously difficult to get a hold of by his constituents.

* The Challenger: Dave Thomas is a construction manager for L.A. County Beach and harbors. He says he is pro-life and believes that climate change is a hoax. He identifies bureaucracy as a problem that saps up budgets meant for issues helping the homeless, he wants to end overspending, and he wants California to open for business again after closing due to the pandemic.

* The Outlook: O'Donnell was able to secure three-quarters of the votes in the primaries, and unless Thomas has a

base of Republican support hidden up his sleeve, O'Donnell will likely win the general.

District 66: Al Muratsuchi (D) vs. Arthur Schaper (R)

* The District: District 66 is home to approximately 467,745 people living in Alondra Park, Hermosa Beach, Lomita, Manhattan Beach, Palos Verdes Estates, Racho Palos Verdes, Redondo Beach, Rolling Hills, Rolling Hills Estates, Torrance, West Carson, and portions of Gardena, Harbor City and Harbor Gateway. About half of the district is White (46.33%), and the other half is primarily Asian (25.73%) and Latino (21.02%). The remaining residents are are mostly Black (4.84%). Despite a Democratic majority (42.72%), a Republican nominee won the seat in 2014.

* The Incumbent: Al Muratsuchi (D-Rolling Hills Estates) has a mixed record over the last year, during which he voted for measures that capped rent increases at 5% a year, and forces debt collectors to leave the final $1,724 in bank accounts, but he also voted against bills that allow formerly incarcerated people to serve on juries, and expedited the process to obtain records of police misconduct in criminal trials. He's received $31,000 in campaign contributions from the Los Angeles Police Protective League, and $37,000 from PORAC, which is the largest statewide law enforcement organization.

* The Challenger: Arthur Schaper is running as a Republican, and has only managed to raise around $1,800 dollars for his campaign. Schaper, a supporter of President Donald Trump and a blogger, is against same-sex marriage, transgender bathroom rights, illegal immigration, and sex education in schools, which he claims was "foisted on us by the LGBTQ agenda."

* The Outlook: In the primaries, Schaper received about half as many votes as Muratsuchi. Additionally the majority of voters in this district are registered Democrats. While not impossible, without the major campaign contributions of his competitor, it seems unlikely that Schaper will be able to overcome Muratsuchi.

District 64: Mike Gipson (D) vs. Fatima Iqbal-Zubair (D)

* The District: The 64th State Assembly District covers parts of South L.A. and the South Bay, including the cities of Carson, Compton, Rancho Dominguez (East and West), Willowbrook, and parts of Long Beach, Broadway-Manchester, Harbor Gateway, Watts and Wilmington. Of the 466,400 residents of District 64, the vast majority of registered voters are Democrats (64.01%). There are more voters without a party than registered Republicans, so it's no surprise the seat was held by the Democrats over the last decade. District 64 is primarily comprised of Latino (62.24%) and Black residents (25.64%), with minorities of Asian (6.68%), White (3.30%) and Hawaiian/Pacific Islanders (1.01%).

* The Incumbent: Mike Gipson (D-Carson) recently sponsored a bill to establish civilian oversight over sheriff's departments. In 2019 he voted no on a bill that would improve transparency concerning the environmental impact of abandoned oil wells. Over the years, Mike Gipson received a total of $146,008 from the pharmaceutical industry, and $170,780 from the oil and gas industry, though most of his contributions are from labor unions.

* The Challenger: Fatima Iqbal-Zubair (D-Watts), a teacher, was endorsed this year by the Democratic Socialists of America, Ground Game LA, and the Sunrise Movement, and she is running on a platform of Medicare-for-all, clean air and water in her district, and ending systemic racism. The majority of contributions to her campaign come from herself and other individuals.

* The Outlook: Mike Gipson received 67% of the votes in the primary, but it's possible for Iqbal-Zabair to catch up. Iqbal-Zabair stands to the left of Gipson, and the many community activist groups she is connected to could help spread the word that she's the politician they want in the Assembly. Whether she wins this time or not, this race could provide the foundation for future campaigns.

District 63: Anthony Rendon (D) vs. Maria Estrada (D)

* The district: District 63 is home to about 461,153 residents spread throughout the cities of Bell, Cudahy, Hawaiian

Gardens, Lakewood, Lynwood, Maywood, Paramount, South Gate, and parts of Long Beach. Over the last decade this seat has been held by Anthony Rendon (D-Lakewood), who has served as the Speaker of the State Assembly since 2016. The district has a large Latino majority (74.20%), with minorities of White (11.13%), Black (7.42%), and Asian residents (5.71%). Over half of the voters in the district are Democrats (56.97%), and there are more voters without a party preference here than there are Republicans.

* The Incumbent: Rendon (D-Lakewood) has a history of voting for progressive measures on the environment, mild police oversight, and mild protections for tenants. Over his career, he has taken $218,000 from the pharmaceutical industry, over $347,000 from the insurance industry, and has accepted money from various law enforcement groups.

* The Challenger: Maria Estrada is running on a platform of Medicare-for-all, rent control, and environmental issues. She's raised around $5,000 primarily from individual donors.

* The Outlook: Estrada, who also ran in 2018, received almost half of the votes in the primaries. It's possible that she could beat out Rendon, but given his prominence as the Speaker of the State Assembly and his significant funding, she's got her work cut out for her.

District 62: Autumn Burke (D) vs. Robert Steele (R)

* The district: District 62 is home to 466,713 people spread throughout the South Bay, Westside, and South L.A. It encompasses the cities of Del Aire, El Segundo, Hawthorne, Lawndale, Lennox, Venice, Marina Del Rey, West Athens, parts of Westchester, Gardena, Westmont, and most of Inglewood. This is another district where over half of the voters are registered Democrats (59.73%) with fewer Republicans than voters without a party preference. The district is also home to LAX. The population is primarily Latino (43.23%), with the remaining population mainly split between Black (25.26%), White (22.84%), and Asian residents (6.50%). The Democrats maintained this seat throughout the last decade, and the incumbent Autumn Burke (D-Marina Del Rey) has been in office since 2014.

* The Incumbent: Autumn Burke has a record of voting progressively on a variety of issues. Over the years, she's accepted over $109,000 in contributions from telecommunications companies like AT&T.

* The Challenger: Robert Steele is running on a Republican platform of building a border wall to keep undocumented Mexicans out, and expanding local law enforcement's ability to work with federal law enforcement. Additionally, he is against mandatory vaccinations and universal healthcare. He is primarily funded by individual donations adding up to about $1,100.

* The Outlook: Steele faces significant obstacles to beating Burke this year. During the primaries, she received almost 85% of the votes. Without much money to fuel the campaign, and without much support for Republicans among voters in this district, it seems unlikely that Steele will win.

District 59: Reginald Jones-Sawyer (D) vs. Efren Martinez (D)

* The district: District 59 encompasses the areas of Florence-Graham, Florence, Historic South Central, University Park, Vermont-Slauson, Walnut Park, parts of Vermont Square, Exposition Park, and Huntington Park. Home to 465,168 people, the vast majority of residents in district 59 are Latino (75.00%), with a minority of Black (19.38%), White (2.60%) and Asian residents (2.05%). A significant majority of voters in this district are Democrats (68.83%), while less than 6% are Republicans. The Democrats have held this seat since 2012.

* The Incumbent: While Reginald "Reggie" Jones-Sawyer often votes in favor of progressive measures on the environment and tenants protections, he has a mixed record on police reform — perhaps the biggest issue on the minds of many voters this year. Criminal justice reform forms part of his platform this year, but he has also accepted over $60,000 from police unions like the LAPPL and the CCPOA.

* The Challenger: Efren Martinez lacks a clear position on a variety of issues, but speaks favorably of small

businesses. He's invested over $300,000 of his own money into his campaign, and has accepted a bit over $9,000 each from Davita and PORAC.

* The Outlook: Between the two, Jones-Sawyer will probably appeal more towards progressives and Martinez will appeal more towards centrists and Republicans. Martinez was able to win more votes than the incumbent in the primary; he just might be able to secure the nomination in November.

District 58: Cristina Garcia (D) vs. Margaret Villa (G)

* The District: District 58 encompasses parts of the Gateway Cities along the 605 from Cerritos to Pico Rivera, and is home to about 468,258 people. Also included in this district are the cities of Artesia, Bell Gardens, Bellflower, Commerce, Downey, Montebello, Norwalk. The majority of voters in this district are Democrats (53.31%), while less than 20% are Republicans, and Democrats have held this seat throughout the last decade. Residents in the district are primarily Latino (67.16%), with Asian (13.91%), White (13.15%), and Black minorities (4.56%).

* The Incumbent: Cristina Garcia has a mixed record on housing and issues regarding internet access and affordability. In the past two years, she abstained from voting on bills that would prevent evictions and restore net neutrality, and voted in favor of a bill that eliminated oversight over telecoms companies. She's accepted over $169,000 from the real estate industry, and $100,000 from telecoms companies.

* The Challenger: Margaret Villa is running on the Green Party ticket, with a platform of Medicare-for-all, and rent control/forgiveness. Thus far, Villa has only raised about $700.

* The Outlook: Villa is the only Green Party candidate running for the state Legislature to make it to the general election. With only 22% of the primary vote, and far less money to spend, it seems unlikely that she will beat Garcia in November.

District 57 Lisa Calderon (D) vs. Jessica Martinez (R)

* The District: Ian Calderon is leaving office at the end of his term this November, and his stepmother Lisa is vying for his seat. Serving as the Assembly Majority Leader, Ian Calderon has held this seat since 2012, succeeding his father. District 57 encompasses the Eastern portion of the Gateway Cities, including Avocado Heights, La Mirada, Hacienda Heights, Industry, La Habra Heights, La Puente, Norwalk, Santa Fe Springs, South El Monte, South San Jose Hills, South Whittier, West Whittier-Los Nietos, and Whittier proper. It's home to about 465,485 residents, the majority of which are Latino (67.74%), with minorities of White (18.18%), Asian (11.39%), and Black residents (1.65%). Almost half of the district's voters are registered Democrats (48.47%), with the remainder split evenly between Republicans and voters without a party preference.

* The Democrat: The Calderons are a California political dynasty in a time of rampant skepticism for establishment politicians. She's running on a platform of half-measures — she supports expanding the ACA instead of Medicare-for-all, and wants to pass laws to clean up pollution rather than prevent it. Her policies seem to reflect the thousands of dollars in campaign contributions that she's received from energy companies.

* The Republican: Jessica Martinez is a first-time candidate who says she wants to bring back jobs by lowering state taxes. A Trump supporter, Martinez posts videos on her campaign's official Facebook declaring that systemic racism and White privilege aren't real, and denouncing "left-wing indoctrination" in schools. One of her proposed plans for unhoused residents of Whittier is to designate an acre of land in an industrial area for them, install porta-johns and wash areas, and then strictly enforce vagrancy laws.

* The Outlook: Despite the vast difference in the amount of money they've been able to raise, Martinez won more votes than Calderon in the primary. However, if you add up all the votes that were given to the different Democratic candidates, Martinez lost handily. The question remains whether she can pull together enough support to beat Calderon, but the majority of the district's voters seem to prefer a Democrat.

District 55 Phillip Chen (R) vs. Andrew Rodriguez (D)

* The District: The affluent 55th District, which straddles L.A., Orange, and San Bernardino counties, is one of the few on this list currently represented by a Republican, and one of the few split about evenly between registered Democrats (35.16%) and Republicans (33.98%), with a lot of independent voters left over to woo. The district is centered on Chino Hills, but also encompasses Brea, Diamond Bar, La Habra, Industry, Placenta, Rowland Heights, Walnut, West Covina, and Yorba Linda — home of Assemblyman Phillip Chen (R). The 461,696 residents living there are split somewhat evenly between White (34.05%), Asian (31.91%), and Latino (29.99%), with a minority of Black residents (2.68%).

* The Incumbent: District 55 is one of the only districts in L.A. County that is currently represented by a Republican. Phillip Chen has received tens of thousands of dollars from police groups, energy companies, and bankers, and his time in office reflects these contributions to the letter.

* The Challenger: Andrew Rodriguez is running a fairly boilerplate Democratic platform without naming many specific policies. His approach to the urgent housing crisis seems to miss the crucial point that Southern California doesn't face a lack of housing inventory, but that the inventory is priced far beyond the paychecks of everyday workers. His proposed solution is to incentivize production of new housing, but how he plans to combat sky-high market prices remains to be seen.

* The Outlook: Rodriguez isn't too far behind Chen, but to clinch the election, he's got to win over either people to his left or his right. People to his left will probably criticize him for not taking a decisive stance on issues, and people to his right will probably vote for Chen.

District 54: Sydney Kamlager (D) vs. Tracy Bernard Jones (D)

* The district: The diverse 54th district encompasses parts of L.A. County including Culver City, Ladera Heights, Baldwin Hills, Century City, Crenshaw, Leimert Park, Mar Vista, Mid-City L.A., West LA Westwood, View Park, and Windsor Hills. The 466,445 residents of this district are split about evenly between Latinos (30.50%), Whites (29.45%), and Blacks (25.20%), with a minority of Asians (12.73%). The vast majority of voters in District 54 are Democrats (62.59%), and the remaining voters are primarily independent. Less than 10% of voters in this district are Republicans.

* The Incumbent: Sydney Kamlager is running for reelection on criminal justice reform, and has authored bills that allow people on parole to vote. She has accepted over $17,000 from the California Apartment Association, which fights against measures like rent control, and the rights of tenants.

* The Challenger: Tracy Bernard Jones is a special education teacher focusing on education issues. He stands against charter schools and fracking, and he wants to expand the ACA in the state.

* The Outlook: Jones trailed behind Kamlager in the primaries, and only secured around half as many votes. Kamlager spells out her platform more clearly, and has the financial benefits of being the incumbent. In the end it's not impossible for Jones to win, just unlikely.

District 53: Miguel Santiago (D) vs. Godfrey Santos Plata (D)

* The district: The largely Latino 53rd District encompasses most of Downtown L.A., as well as areas of Huntington Park, Boyle Heights, Koreatown, Little Tokyo, Pico-Union, Westlake, and Vernon. The majority of voters in district 53 are Democrats (58.52%), and they've held onto this seat for over a decade. Of the 463,916 people in this district, over two-thirds are Latino (68.32%), with a minority of Asian (18.25%), White (7.23%), and Black residents (5.23%). There are more independent voters in this district than registered Republicans.

* The Incumbent: During his time in office Miguel Santiago has authored progressive measures to fight against climate change, rent hikes, and to open public banks. He's received contributions from telecoms, energy, unions,

and pharmaceutical companies.

* The Challenger: A gay immigrant from the Philippines, Godfrey Santos Plata is endorsed by community organizations fighting for economic and housing justice, such as Ground Game LA, Our Revolution LA, and the Sunrise Movement. He has pledged to not take any money from the police.

* The Outlook: Like so many challengers, Plata received about half of the votes in the primary as Santiago, but with endorsements from local organizations which excite young socialists, and a clear policy agenda, he's got a shot at a large group of voters looking to break with Democratic party norms. It's a tough fight, but one that socialists are sure to win in the years to come.

District 52: Freddie Rodriguez (D) vs. Toni Holle (R)

* District 52: The suburban 52nd district represents 465,678 people across parts of L.A. and San Bernardino counties, including Pomona, Chino, Montclair, and Ontario. The residents of this district are mainly Latino (68.08%), with White (17.22%), Asian (7.42%), and Black minorities (5.99%). About half of the voters here are Democrats (48.10%), with the rest split between Republican and independent voters, though independents are slightly more numerous.

* The Incumbent: Since taking office in 2013, Rodriguez has become notorious for abstaining from difficult votes regarding affordable housing, climate change, the rights of workers, and mass incarceration, often in spite of support for such measures from his constituents. During his career he has accepted thousands in campaign contributions from big oil, big pharma, and law enforcement.

* The Challenger: Toni Holle is running on a platform of lowering taxes, increasing funding for the police, and ending mandatory vaccinations. She says that to help the homeless, we should not provide housing, but should put homeless people in drug treatment facilities — by force if necessary.

* The Outlook: The party names might be different, but both candidates are essentially right-wing. By continually abstaining from votes, Rodriguez is basically voting 'no' on a variety of issues that his district supports. With a majority Democrat base in the district, and a variety of Republican interests already being served by the current candidate, it seems unlikely that Holle will clinch a win.

District 51: Wendy Carrillo (D) — Unopposed

Wendy Carrillo (D-Boyle Heights) is running unopposed in District 51. The district encompasses parts of East Los Angeles, Chinatown, Cypress Park, Eagle Rock, Echo Park, El Sereno, Glassell Park, Highland Park, Lincoln Heights, Montecito Heights, and Silver Lake, and is home to 465,643 people.

The residents of District 51 are mainly Latino (71.60%), with Asian (14.28%), White (10.981%), and Black minorities (2.33%). Over the last decade, the Democrats were able to hold this seat.

More than half of the voters here are Democrats (60.73%), while less than 10% of voters are Republicans.

District 50: Richard Bloom (D) vs. Will Hess (D)

* The district: The district's 470,048 residents are spread across Agoura Hills, Beverly Hills, Bel Air, Brentwood, Hollywood, Mid-Wilshire, Pacific Palisades, Malibu, Santa Monica, Topanga, and West Hollywood. After winning the seat in 2012, the Democrats have been able to hold onto it for the rest of the decade. Over half of the voters here are Democrats (52.59%), significantly more than Republicans (16.23%). Over two-thirds of the people living here are White (71.25%), and the rest are mainly Latino (12.00%), Asian (11.08%) and Black (4.15%).

* The Incumbent: Richard Bloom has held this seat since 2012, and has used his time in office to sponsor bills to protect tenants, including a failed bill to authorize rent control, and a recent bill that prevents COVID-19 related

evictions until February 2021.

* The Challenger: Will Hess, perhaps better known for his 2010 documentary "With Great Power: The Stan Lee Story" is running a campaign with a mixed bag of views. One of the primary issues of his platform is eradicating homelessness — something he wants to achieve by building a large campus outside of L.A., where unhoused persons will get "three hots and a cot" along with access to medical care, job placement, social programs, and aid in moving to affordable housing. He's against NIMBYs, illegal immigration, and Black Lives Matter. He's for the Second Amendment, infrastructure expansion, and banning all Chinese investment in U.S. media.

* The Outlook: This seems to be a shoo-in for Bloom. Hess' ideas aren't fleshed out enough to lead to meaningful policy changes, and with little money and few primary votes, it's unlikely he will be able to mount an effective challenge to the incumbent.

District 49: Edwin Chau (D) vs. Burton Brink (R)

* The district: About 462,545 people live in District 49, spread across parts of Alhambra, Arcadia, El Monte, Montebello, Monterey Park, Rosemead, San Gabriel, San Marino, South El Monte, and Temple City. About half of the residents of this district are Asian (53.36%), with many Latinos (32.47%), and White (12.50%) and Black minorities (0.86%). The majority of voters in the district are Democrats (42.41%), while about half of that are Republicans (20.12%). This seat has been held securely by the Democrats for over two decades.

* The Incumbent: Edwin Chau is perhaps best known for introducing the California Consumer Privacy Act, which gives consumers the right to deny sale of their data, and to know what data is being collected from them.

* The Challenger: The former deputy sheriff and Sgt. Burton Brink is running against Chau for the second term in a row, but it doesn't appear that he's gained much more ground. His largest campaign contributions came from various law enforcement agencies, and he is running on a platform of lowering taxes and fighting crime. He wants to bring businesses back to the San Gabriel Valley, strictly enforce immigration, and restore local control over education.

* The Outlook: Unless Brink is able to amass enough support from Democrats to push him over the edge, this race will likely go to Chau.

District 48: Blanca Rubio (D) — Unopposed

Blanca Rubio (D-Baldwin Park) is running unopposed in District 48, which is home to 461,346 people throughout Azusa, Baldwin Park, Bradbury, Covina, Duarte, El Monte, Glendora, Irwindale, Monrovia, Valinda, and most of West Covina.

The Democrats have held this seat for the past decade, and almost half of the voters are Democrats (47.25%).

The remaining voters are split between independents and Republicans, with the independents in the slight majority.

Most of the people living in District 48 are Latino (64.04%), White (19.40%), Asian (12.86%), or Black (2.66%).

District 46: Adrin Nazarian (D) vs. Lanira K. Murphy (D)

* The district: District 46 encompasses about 464,441 people spread throughout the San Fernando Valley, and includes portions of Hollywood Hills, Lake Balboa, North Hills, North Hollywood, Panorama City, Sherman Oaks, Studio City, Toluca Lake, Valley Glen, Valley Village, Van Nuys, and Universal City. The Democrats in the Assembly have held this seat since they won it in 2012. Around half of the voters here are Democrats (53.34%), and most of the remaining voters are independent. Most of the district is Latino (44.39%), White, (39.98%), Asian (9.25%), or Black (4.69%).

* The Incumbent: Adrin Nazarian is the first Iranian-American to be elected to the state Legislature. He sponsored AB3088, a recent stopgap measure to protect tenants from evictions.

* The Challenger: Lanira K. Murphy is a teacher-turned-treasurer of the Panorama City Neighborhood Council. She wants to repeal AB5, increase funding for education, and prioritize transparency in drug prices.

* The Outlook: With almost 70% of the votes in the primaries, Nazarian seems likely to win against Murphy.

District 45: Jesse Gabriel (D) vs. Jeffi Girgenti (R)

* The district: District 45 encompasses about 467,766 people spread throughout L.A. and Ventura counties, including Calabasas, Hidden Hills, Canoga Park, Encino, Northridge, Reseda, West Hills, Winnetka, Woodland Hills, Tarzana, and Bell Canyon. The Democrats held this seat throughout the last decade. About half of all voters in District 45 are Democrats, with the remainder split about evenly between Republicans and independent voters, though the independents are in the slight majority. Most of the people living in this district are White (49.86%), Latino (30.38%), Asian (13.84%), or Black (4.46%).

* The Incumbent: Jesse Gabriel, who twice sued the Trump administration over DACA, is now running for his second term in District 45. While a Democrat, he's certainly not a progressive.

* The Challenger: Jeffi Girgenti, a small business owner, received over 900 write-in votes in the primary, and will be allowed to face Gabriel in the general due to the top two-system. She wants to repeal AB5, increase penalties for people with substance abuse disorders, and supports charter schools.

* The Outlook: Girgenti has her work cut out for her if she wants to beat Gabriel in the general.

District 44: Jacqui Irwin (D) vs. Denise Pedrow (R)

* The district: District 44 is home to about 462,271 people spread across L.A. and Ventura counties, including Westlake Village, Camarillo, Moorpark, Oak Park, Oxnard, Port Hueneme, and Thousand Oaks. Incumbent Jacqui Irwin (D-Thousand Oaks) first gained her seat from the Republicans in 2014, and has maintained it until now. While there are more Democratic voters (41.85%), there is a much higher concentration of Republicans (31.66%) than in other districts. Most of the people living in District 44 are White (45.30%), Latino (42.55%), Asian (8.69%), or Black (2.07%).

* The Incumbent: Jacqui Irwin, the former Thousand Oaks mayor, is not a progressive Democrat, but skews center-right on several issues.

* The Challenger: Republican opponent Denise Pedrow wants to shrink the government, lower taxes, and fund law enforcement. She stands against rent control, and wants to reopen churches for public worship.

* The Outlook: Irwin is ahead of her competitor, but not as far ahead as other candidates in other districts. There is a possible world out there where Pedrow wins.

District 43: Laura Friedman (D) vs. Mike Graves (R)

* The district: District 43 is home to about 468,406 people mainly spread across the eastern end of the San Fernando Valley. It encompasses the areas of Burbank, Glendale, La Cañada Flintridge, La Crescenta-Montrose, Hollywood Hills, East Hollywood, Little Armenia, Los Feliz, Silver Lake, and Atwater Village. This seat has been held by Democrats for over two decades. There is a clear majority of Democratic voters (46.87%) compared to Republicans (20.68%). Most of the people living in District 43 are White (55.92%), Latino (23.32%), Asian (17.24%), and Black (2.22%).

* The Incumbent: Laura Friedman has an outstanding record of voting in favor of progressive policies, and worked

with other Democrats to sponsor bills to restrict use of force by law enforcement. She is the author of important bills to protect the environment, including one to reduce greenhouse gas emissions from commercial and residential buildings by 40% by 2030.

* The Challenger: Mike Graves owns a toffee house, and is tired of California's high taxes. He wants to increase local control of school districts, and lower the costs of government in the state. After opposing him for the first years of his presidency, Graves recently came out in favor of Donald Trump.

* The Outlook: Friedman probably doesn't have much to worry about from Graves, who received only 20% of votes in the primary.

District 41: Chris Holden (D) vs. Robin A. Hvidston (R)

* The district: District 41 is home to about 462,507 people spread across the San Gabriel Mountains, including Pasadena, La Verne, Monrovia, Pasadena, San Dimas, Sierra Madre, South Pasadena, Rancho Cucamonga, San Antonio Heights, and Upland. After winning in 2012, Chris Holden (D-Pasadena) has been able to maintain his seat until this year. Most voters in this district are Democrats (44.43%) or Republicans (28.50%). Most of the people living in District 41 are White (46.11%), Latino (30.73%), Asian (13.00%), or Black (8.49%).

* The Incumbent: Chris Holden, the former mayor and city councilmember of Pasadena, has an outstanding record of voting in favor of progressive policies, and recently has sponsored bills to restrict the use of force by law enforcement. He was instrumental in connecting Pasadena to L.A. with the Metro Gold Line.

* The Challenger: Robin Hvidston says she is pro-law enforcement, pro-business, and wants to build the border wall. She opposes any plan to change Prop 13.

* The Outlook: With almost 70% of the votes in the primary, Holden is way out ahead of Hvidston, whose tough on crime stance could make or break her campaign.

District 39: Luz Rivas (D) vs. Ricardo Benitez (R)

* The district: District 39 is home to 466,422 people spread throughout Arleta, Lake View Terrace, Mission Hills, North Hollywood, Pacoima, Sun Valley, Sunland-Tujunga, Sylmar, and San Fernando. The Democrats have held this seat for over a decade, and over half of the voters of this district are Democrats (52.94%). The remaining voters are mostly independent. Most of the people in this district are Latino (68.47%), White (20.31%), Asian (6.84%), or Black (3.30%).

* The Incumbent: Luz Rivas, the former L.A. Public Works Commissioner, usually votes in favor of progressive policies, and is endorsed by Mayor Eric Garcetti. She beat Benitez in the 2018 election for the same seat.

* The Challenger: Ricardo Benitez operates a contracting business, has unsuccessfully run for various offices over the last decade. This year he was a plaintiff in a suit filed against Gov. Gavin Newsom over a statewide assistance program meant to help immigrants not covered by the CARES Act.

* The Outlook: This year's primary looked eerily similar to 2018's general election, where Rivas beat out Benitez with around three-quarters of the votes. One can expect a similar result in the general.

District 38: Suzette Martinez Valladares (R) vs. Lucie Lapointe Volotzky (R)

* The district: District 38 is home to about 469,883 people living in the LA and Ventura counties, and encompasses Agua Dulce, Castaic, Granada Hills, Porter Ranch, Santa Clarita, Stevenson Ranch, and Simi Valley. Politically, this district is split almost evenly between Democrats (34.28%), Republicans (33.44%), and independents (26.78%). Republicans held this seat throughout the last decade, and since Christy Smith (D-Santa Clarita) is leaving office at the end of this term, this seat is guaranteed to one of the two Republicans on the ballot. Most of the people living in

district 38 are White (55.62%) or Latino (25.77%), with minorities of Asian (13.41%) and Black residents (3.55%).

* The challengers

* Suzette Martinez Valladares is one of two Republican nominees for District 38 this year. The granddaughter of a Bakersfield farmworker, she is endorsed by the LAPPL and other law enforcement groups. She says she wants to focus on early childhood education and advocacy.

* Lucie Lapointe Volotzky is the other Republican to emerge from the top-two primary earlier this year. She is in favor of charter schools, wants to reduce tuition costs for students forced to take their university education online, she wants to be tough on crime, and vows that she will not vote for new taxes.

* The Outlook: This election is definitely a toss up, but Valladares has the leg up. During the primary, she pulled ahead, and with major endorsements from local law enforcement.

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